FINANCIAL DECISION BRIEF

Wincheck
Pricing, cash & hiring

October 2026–September 2027 · USD · Prepared 11 October 2026

Keep the proposed prices. Customer growth—not AI usage cost—is the constraint on hiring.

> **Base decision:** reach 23 paying repositories to cover founder pay. Reach 56 to cover founder pay plus the $6,000/month contractor. Base ends at 30.

Pricing that clears 70% margin

Offering	Price	Variable delivery margin
Pay per successful fix	$49	96.9%
Team: 10 fixes per repository	$199/month	92.5%
Additional team fix	$29	94.8%

The variable-cost floor is **$5 per successful fix**: $1.50 ÷ (1 − 70%). Including hosting, the floor is ($1.50 + $50/F) ÷ 30%, where F is monthly paid successful fixes. With only 10 paid fixes, the floor rises to $21.67.

One fully used team has a **67.3% hosting-inclusive margin**; two have **79.9%**. Payment fees and support labor are excluded.

September 2027 outcomes

Outcome	Base	Upside	Downside
Paying repositories	30	60	12
Monthly revenue	$5,970	$11,940	$2,388
Monthly operating cash flow	$1,355	$875	−$1,957
Minimum funding through year	$4,938	$0	$17,500
First revenue-funded engineer	Not in plan	September	Not in plan

Cash flow includes the engineer only when the revenue gate clears. Funding assumes zero starting cash and same-month collections. Upside still needs cash for bills arriving before receipts. Dollar amounts are rounded in this brief.

ASSUMPTIONS & DECISIONS

Protect cash before hiring

Monthly break-even

Cost coverage	Teams	Subscription revenue
Hosting, tools and free-project use	1	$199
Above + founder pay	23	$4,577
Above + contract engineer	56	$11,144

Each team contributes $184: $199 revenue less $15 for ten successful fixes. Monthly overhead is $150. Ten free projects, at one successful fix each, add $15/month.

Funding and the first hire

- **Base:** minimum funding is $4,937.50, with the deepest cash gap in July. It returns to positive monthly operating cash flow in August after founder pay begins.
- **Downside:** minimum funding is $17,499.50 through September.
- **Upside:** the model clears the hire gate in September at 60 teams. Monthly cash flow after that hire is $875.
- **Hiring in July anyway:** Base requires $21,147.50 through September and is still burning $4,645/month in September.

> **Recommendation:** plan around $17,500 available cash—Base's peak gap plus roughly three months of founder pay and existing costs ($12,495). This is not a contractor reserve. Prefer three months at or above 56 teams before committing, then check bank cash and retention.

What the forecast assumes

- One founder; pre-revenue prototype. Founder pay is $0 for months 1–6 and $4,000/month from April 2027.
- All teams use ten included fixes. No standalone paid fixes or extra-fix revenue is assumed.
- Free projects rise from 3 in October to 6 in November and 10 from December; one successful fix per free project monthly. This is an Ari estimate.
- Base reaches 2 teams by December, 5 by March and 30 by September. Intermediate months, Upside and Downside paths are Ari estimates; all are net paying-repository counts.
- The earliest hire month is July. Hiring is gated by monthly operating contribution covering the contractor, and remains in place afterward.
- No financing or collection delays. Cash movement is not an actual bank balance.

Evidence limits: two successes from three bugs are too small a sample to establish future success rates. The model retains the founder's cautious $1.50 per successful fix. Taxes, payment processing, refunds, acquisition spend, support/review time, founder reimbursements and personal living costs before founder pay are excluded. Base means Main Scenario in the live model.

MONTHLY SCENARIO APPENDIX

The 12-month path

Net paying repositories and operating cash flow, including revenue-gated hiring.

Month	Paying repositories			Operating cash flow		
	Base	Upside	Downside	Base	Upside	Downside
Oct 2026	0	1	0	−$154	$30	−$154
Nov 2026	1	2	0	$25	$209	−$159
Dec 2026	2	4	1	$203	$571	$19
Jan 2027	3	6	1	$387	$939	$19
Feb 2027	4	9	2	$571	$1,491	$203
Mar 2027	5	12	2	$755	$2,043	$203
Apr 2027	8	17	3	−$2,693	−$1,037	−$3,613
May 2027	11	23	4	−$2,141	$67	−$3,429
Jun 2027	15	30	5	−$1,405	$1,355	−$3,245
Jul 2027	20	40	7	−$485	$3,195	−$2,877
Aug 2027	25	50	9	$435	$5,035	−$2,509
Sep 2027	30	60	12	$1,355	$875	−$1,957

How to use the exported model

The Excel workbook contains the saved assumptions, monthly forecast, scenario comparison and early-hire stress tests. The PDF is a static summary; it does not reproduce the interactive cash slider or walkthrough.

For the live model, edit prices and costs in **Pricing and operating assumptions**, and net customer counts or usage in **Monthly operating and hiring forecast**. Use **Scenario comparison** for alternative customer paths. The cash simulator lets you preview a hypothetical starting balance without changing the saved plan.

All scenarios are planning estimates, not approved budgets or sales commitments. Confirm actual available cash, payment timing and demand before starting founder pay or hiring.